

**SYNTHETIC COURT DOCUMENT — FICTIONAL CASE — NOT AN
ACTUAL FILING**

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT FOR THE WESTERN DISTRICT OF VIRGINIA —
CERTIFIED-RECORD PROCEEDING Civil Action No. SYN-WDVA-25-CV-0733

Certified District Docket and Record Certificate

Certified January 30, 2026.

The Clerk certifies the district docket and designated record in *Mara Ellison v. Officer Nolan Rusk*. The interlocutory appeal opened as fictional Fourth Circuit No. SYN-CA4-26-CV-4104. The district action remains pending because the January 9 order denied summary judgment and did not enter final judgment.

The certified lower record contains exactly thirty-seven unique PDF documents and 275 continuous, searchable pages. It consists of four pleadings; six dispatch, police, medical, and follow-up records; six body-camera transcript, timing, field-of-view, audio, and authentication records; eight deposition or expert items; seven qualified-immunity motion and fact-statement items; one dispositive order; and five initiation, appeal, transcript, docket, or certification items.

Page ranges below identify continuous record pagination without adding a factual finding. Native media remain referenced through authenticated district exhibits and hashes. The PDFs contain the searchable authored record used for this training appeal. Routine electronic notices and duplicate administrative copies are omitted rather than counted as separate substantive documents.

Certificate — pleadings and initiation history

The complaint and jury demand, filed April 7, appears at record pages 1–9. The original defendants' April 28 answer occupies pages 10–16. Ellison's May 12 amended complaint, pages 17–24, removes the City of Alder Creek and Chief Samuel Orton and leaves one individual-capacity excessive-force claim against Rusk. Rusk's May 27 answer to that pleading is at pages 25–31.

The civil cover, summons, and waiver packet filed at initiation is preserved at pages 254–256. The April 9 case-assignment and scheduling order is at pages 257–260. Their placement near the end of the assembled pagination reflects the agreed document plan, not a change in filing date.

The scheduling order directed preservation of native cameras, dispatch media, device logs, and metadata and set discovery and motion dates. It did not decide service, liability, or immunity. Later pleadings control the party list. No municipal or supervisory claim was pending when the Court decided summary judgment, and the certified caption for the appeal therefore identifies Ellison and Rusk.

Certificate — dispatch, police, medical, and follow-up records

The 911 welfare-call transcript and CAD event record is at pages 32–38. It records Iris Ellison's February 3 request, a medication or mental-health concern, no known weapon, and dispatch at 19:47:36. Rusk's incident and force report, pages 39–44, and Vega's supplemental report, pages 45–50, preserve different witness positions concerning the close encounter.

The EMS patient-care report occupies pages 51–56. The emergency-department and imaging compilation is at pages 57–63. The crisis stabilization and follow-up records appear at pages 64–68. Together, the clinical items fix the bounded injury description: wrist abrasion, two superficial contact burns, shoulder strain, and no fracture. They do not reconstruct hand movements before the medical crew arrived.

The call and police reports were lodged with Rusk's November 21 motion materials; the follow-up compilation was designated with Ellison's December 12 opposition. Dates within an exhibit remain the dates of the underlying event or record. Lodging an exhibit did not convert an attributed statement into an undisputed fact.

Certificate — body-camera, timing, and authentication records

The certified transcript of Rusk's recording spans pages 69–76. His neutral frame-sequence and time map is at pages 77–82. The separately prepared occlusion and field-of-view analysis appears at pages 83–89. Vega's second-angle transcript occupies pages 90–96.

The synchronized camera-audio and dispatch comparison is at pages 97–101. Sergeant Lila Grant's custodian declaration and export log follows at pages 102–106. These six items preserve native identifiers, source integrity, clock treatment, visible content, and limitations without using a generated reconstruction.

The agreed chronology places wrist control around 19:53:02, restricted camera views from about 19:53:08 through 19:53:22, and one drive-stun cycle from approximately 19:53:16 through 19:53:21. Neither officer recording reliably shows the disputed hands relative to Rusk's forearm and belt during the pivotal interval. Certification of continuity and authenticity does not certify that a strike or reach occurred or that it did not occur.

Certificate — depositions and expert material

Mara Ellison's September 16 deposition excerpts occupy pages 107–117, and Nolan Rusk's September 18 examination occupies pages 118–130. Iris Ellison's September 22 deposition follows at pages 131–140. Officer Priya Vega's September 24 deposition is at pages 141–150, and Paramedic Mateo Cole's September 29 testimony is at pages 151–159.

Dr. Dana North's police-practices report and deposition excerpts appear at pages 160–169. Professor Adrian Crane's video and human-factors report and excerpts occupy pages 170–178. Retired Captain Rowan Pike's defense use-of-force report and excerpts are at pages 179–186.

The witness accounts preserve the factual conflict. The experts use express alternative assumptions and do not choose credibility. North criticizes the force on Ellison's no-danger facts; Pike supports the one-cycle response on Rusk's strike-and-equipment-reach facts but not under the same no-danger assumption; Crane concludes the authentic media constrain timing without resolving the hidden acts. Their inclusion does not make an expert the historical factfinder.

Certificate — summary-judgment and qualified-immunity filings

Rusk's November 21 summary-judgment motion is at pages 187–193. His supporting qualified-immunity memorandum occupies pages 194–205, and his statement of facts is at pages 206–212. These papers argue that the asserted strike and duty-belt movement justified one contact cycle and that prior law did not clearly prohibit the response.

Ellison's December 12 opposition spans pages 213–225. Her response to Rusk's fact statement is at pages 226–232. She argues that Rule 56 requires the Court to assume pain recoil and pulling without a strike, reach, flight, or immediate threat and that pre-event Fourth Circuit precedent supplied fair notice.

Rusk's December 23 reply appears at pages 233–237. The joint body-camera objections and record- citation chart is at pages 238–241. The chart distinguishes visible events, audible words, witness attribution, and competing inference. The full seven-document set is certified so neither the legal briefs nor the media limitation can be detached from the factual dispute presented to the district judge.

Certificate — order and appellate initiation

Judge Elaine Mercer's January 9 memorandum opinion and order occupies pages 242–253. It denies Rusk's motion without entering final judgment. The opinion first identifies a genuine factual dispute over the alleged forearm strike, belt reach, and immediate danger. It then holds as a matter of law that, on specified Ellison-favorable assumptions, the force violated a clearly established right.

Rusk filed his notice of interlocutory appeal on January 16; it appears at pages 261–263. The notice invokes collateral-order review only to the extent available and does not identify an unentered final judgment. The Fourth Circuit assigned No. SYN-CA4-26-CV-4104 after the district clerk transmitted the opening materials.

The January 26 no-transcript form and record designation occupies pages 264–267. No judicial hearing produced a transcript because the motion was decided on the papers. Police audio and body-camera media are exhibits, not court-reporter proceedings. This certificate itself occupies pages 268–275 and completes the designated lower record through January 30.

Certificate — completeness, totals, and preserved boundary

The page ranges are continuous: pleadings 1–31; event and clinical records 32–68; camera and authentication materials 69–106; depositions and experts 107–186; immunity motion papers 187–241; the denial order 242–253; and initiation, appeal, designation, and certification materials 254–275. The seven category subtotals are 4, 6, 6, 8, 7, 1, and 5 documents, totaling 37.

The clerk's cross-check found no duplicate substantive PDF, missing page within an item, or page range overlap. Each designated document has a title, source entry, filing or underlying date, and planned page count. Native media identity is preserved separately and is not inflated into additional record PDFs.

Certification does not resolve the encounter. The district court's evidence-sufficiency ruling leaves the strike, reach, and threat history disputed. Its legal qualified-immunity conclusion uses assumed plaintiff facts and does not find those facts true. The record remains complete only when both parts of that boundary travel together.

I certify the foregoing docket and record description on January 30, 2026.

Fictional Clerk of the United States District Court